



NETBOOKS FOR YOU

While notebooks are a bit heavy to carry around in hand, smartphones are not PCs and have a tiny keypad so you can't type documents easily. Enter netbooks. Smaller and lighter than notebooks, these pack the basic functions of a notebook and almost comparable keypad

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Are you fascinated by that small-size notebook-type gadget in the hand of a businessman? If you are tempted to buy one for yourself, why not first understand what it does and what it doesn't.

A netbook cannot execute high-end applications like gaming and rendering, but it can perform a host of functions such as showing movies,

surfing the Internet, chatting, blogging, streaming content, sharing videos and photos, reading an eBook, and keying in Word and Excel documents.

But if you want the full mobile PC experience, high multitasking performance, high-definition entertainment and great 3D experience on a full-size keyboard with a larger screen, a netbook is not the device for you—you should rather choose a full-featured laptop.

However, if you want an Internet device with basic functions of a net-

book, you may go for a netbook. The absence of an optical disk drive (ODD) in a netbook might be a deterrent for you, but then it is a trade-off between being a bulky and heavy machine versus being portable and light. And, today, there are external USB-based optical drives that make the task simple. External USB optical drives also make economic sense as one ODD can be purchased for usage with multiple netbooks.

How is it different?

From a notebook. Netbooks and notebooks cater to different needs of the consumers. While a notebook is a productivity device meant for higher capabilities like high-end gaming, high-end computing and high-end software, netbooks are positioned to bridge the gap between smart phones and notebooks. These take the idea of a notebook PC further, creating a new market above handheld computers, smart phones and personal digital assistants. They are lighter and smaller than notebooks—pretty similar to the average diary. Also, they cost less than a standard notebook.

While a notebook may cost you Rs 20,000-Rs 100,000, netbooks are generally available for Rs 15,000-Rs 35,000. There is not much of a price difference between netbooks because a netbook has not been defined as an entry-level laptop. Rather, it's positioned as an Internet device with normal functions of a 35.6cm (14-inch) laptop.

Netbooks are normally below 30.5 cm (12 inches) in size, have no DVD ROM and are mainly based on Intel Atom CPU. These typically have less powerful hardware than larger notebook computers. They usually do not even have a conventional hard drive. Some netbooks use solidstate storage devices, as these require less power and are lighter and generally more shock-resistant. However, these drives come with much less storage capacity of 8, 16 or 32 GB compared to 80-160GB mechanical hard drives typical of many notebooks.